

RANRAN LI

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ACADEMIC POSITION

2025 – Postdoctoral researcher (Humboldt Postdoc Fellow since 2026)
Department of Criminology, Host: Jean-Louis van Gelder
Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security and Law, Germany

EDUCATION

2020 – 2025 PhD in Personality Psychology
Dissertation: Unlocking Personality: How situational strength and situational affordances shape behavioral expression (Supervisors: Reinout E. de Vries, Daniel Balliet, Isabel Thielmann). <https://doi.org/10.5463/thesis.1256>
Tanaka Dissertation Award (2026), Association for Research in Personality
Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Netherlands

2024 – 25 PhD research visit, *Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security, and Law*

2018 – 2020 Research Master's in Psychology (with merit): 8.3/10.
University of Amsterdam, Netherlands

2016 – 17 Global Exchange: 1.3/6. *University of Münster, Germany*

2014 – 2018 BSc in Psychology (distinction): 94/100.
Soochow University, Taiwan

RESEARCH STATEMENT

With the belief that ‘*Serious inquiry into human nature is not a luxury*,’ I study how personality traits and situational factors interact to shape human behavior, in particular, prosocial and moral behavior. I am currently applying this **person–situation interaction perspective** to the study of bystander intervention (i.e., how people remain prosocial when situations make it difficult to do so). I integrate rigorous empirical methods with theoretical integration.

While psychology remains my ‘*Forever Moonlight*’ and intellectual foundation, I have interdisciplinary interests and pursuits. At present, I am actively bridging psychology with criminology, behavioral economics, and sociocultural perspectives. I am additionally interested in philosophy of science (meta-science) and computational social science. I see myself as a bridge and builder across disciplines.

Support good science – open, rigorous, and trustworthy science – always on the way.

PUBLICATIONS

Forthcoming

De Vries, R. E., & Li, R. (forthcoming). Superfluous states, facet fallacies, and psychometric problems in the Whole Trait Theory. *European Journal of Personality*. [Preprint]

Li, R., Thielmann, I., Balliet, D., & De Vries, R. (R&R 2nd round submitted). When dishonesty pays off: Incentives foster trait activation of Honesty-Humility. *Personality Science*. [Preprint]

◇ Received iBBA Online Experiment Grant €2,500, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

{person-situation processes; dishonesty}

{method: experimental cheating games}

2026

Li, R., De Vries, R. E., & Van Gelder, J.-L. (2026). Entangled pathways to delinquency: An integrative process model of personality, situations, and macro-structures. *Zeitschrift für Psychologie*. <https://doi.org/10.1027/2151-2604/a000629>

◇ Co-organizing a panel at the European Society of Criminology (ESC), Warsaw, Sept 2026, “Virtual Reality as a window into crime: Personality, situations, and psychological processes”

{person-situation processes}

{method: theoretical integration}

Ye, Z., Long, F., Feng, R., van Dijk, W., & Li, R. (2026). People feel but don't tell: Dispositional honesty and emotional responses to others' (mis)fortunes. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology*, 126, 104966. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jesp.2026.104966>

{empathy, prosociality, morality}

{method: vignette; diary; real-time interaction studies}

2025

Li, R., & Wilt, J. A. (2025). Situated selves: A cyclical model of personality expression in context. *Current Opinion in Psychology*, 102104. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.copsyc.2025.102104>

{person-situation processes}

{method: theoretical integration}

Van Gelder, J.-L., Li, R., Wiechert, S., & Frankenhuys, W. E. (2025). Short-term mindsets: Beyond traits and self-regulation. *Current Opinion in Psychology*, 102112. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.copsyc.2025.102112>

{method: theoretical}

Li, R., & Zettler, I. (2025). Entangled Minds: A roadmap for bridging cultural and personality psychology research. *Personality Science*, 6. <https://doi.org/10.1177/27000710251388772>

{personality x cultural psychology}

{method: theoretical integration}

Li, R., Thielmann, I., Balliet, D., & De Vries, R. E. (2025). Trait activation in daily life: Comparing two perspectives on person-situation interactions. *Journal of Research in Personality*, 104689.

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jrp.2025.104689>

◇ Received SeedCorn Research Grant €3,000 for the project, Kurt Lewin Institute

◇ Organized a symposium at the International Convention of Psychological Science (ICPS), Brussels, Mar 2023, “Trait and situation activation in daily life and organizational settings”

{person-situation processes}
{method: diary study}

2024

Li, R., Balliet, D., Thielmann, I., & De Vries, R. E. (2024). Revisiting situational strength: Do strong situations restrict variance in behaviors? *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 129(3), 551–575. <https://doi.org/10.1037/pspi0000475>

◇ Received multiple awards for the paper, including Best Paper Award @ Dutch Work & Organizational Psychology conference, Tilburg, Netherlands (2022), Runner-up for the Best Paper Award, Kurt Lewin Institute, Netherlands (2024), and Best Student Presentation Award at the International Conference on Social Dilemmas, Leiden, Netherlands (2024).

◇ Chaired a methodological session “Methodological Advances in OB research” at the Academy of Management (AOM), Boston, Aug 2023.

{person-situation processes; prosocial behavior}
{method: social dilemma games; meta-analysis}

2023

Li, R., Thielmann, I., Balliet, D., & De Vries, R. E. (2023). Development of the Generic Situational Strength (GSS) scale: Measuring situational strength across contexts. In L. R. Ford & T. A. Scandura (Eds.), *The SAGE Handbook of Survey Development and Application*. <https://doi.org/10.4135/9781529617757.n35>

{method: scale development}

Li, R. (2023). Revisiting person–situation interactionism. *Nature Reviews Psychology*, 2, 6. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s44159-022-00139-8>

{person-situation processes}

> Manuscripts in the pipeline

Li, R., Knabe, M., Derakhshan, S., Arui, A.-K., & Van Gelder, J.-L. (R&R). Beyond immersion and presence: Rethinking validity in Virtual Reality criminology. [Preprint]

{method: conceptual; Virtual Reality}

He, Y., & **Li, R.** (under review). Prosociality under risk: A conceptual synthesis and roadmap for future research. [Preprint]

{prosocial behavior}

> Work in progress

Li, R., De Vries, R. E., Barnum, T., Herman, S., Tisdall, L., Van Gelder, J.-L. A trait–state model of reactive guardianship: Psychological pathways to bystander intervention. *Manuscript in preparation* [Preprint].

{bystander intervention}
{method: Virtual Reality scenario}

Li, R., Van Gelder, J.-L., & De Vries, R. E. Who goes where and why? A meta-analytic review of personality and situation selection. *Manuscript in preparation*.

{person-situation processes}
{method: meta-analysis}

Umashev, N., **Li, R.**, Rusch, H. Agent incentives: How agents trade off incentives and exploitation risk in principal selection. *Manuscript in preparation*.

{personality; exploitation}
{method: micro experimental economics}

van Lissa, C., Ballou, N., **Li, R.**, et al. Self-determination theory: Theory specification. *Manuscript in preparation*.

{method: computational modeling}

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Slides/posters available at osf.io/a83tv

Panel Co-organizer: European Society of Criminology (ESC), Warsaw, Sept 2026: “Virtual Reality as a window into crime: Personality, situations, and psychological processes”

Symposium Organizer: International Convention of Psychological Science (ICPS), Brussels, Mar 2023: “Trait and situation activation in daily life and organizational settings”

Session Moderator: Academy of Management (AOM), Boston, Aug 2023: “Methodological Advances in OB Research”

Other presentations (selected):

(Personality) Psychology	European Conference of Personality (ECP) ^{1,2,3} ; Summer School of Personality Science ² ;	¹ Edinburgh, July 2026; ² Berlin, Aug 2024; ³ Madrid, Aug 2022;
	Association for Research in Personality (ARP) ^{1,2} ;	Chicago, July 2023; June 2027;
	German Differentielle Psychologie (DPPD) conference;	Kassel, Sept 2025;
	Chinese Personality Psychology conference	Beijing, Dec 2024;
	Kurt Lewin Institute (KLI) Conference;	Utrecht, April 2024;
Criminology	German Psychological Science Congress (DGPs);	Luxembourg, Sept 2026;
	European Society of Criminology (ESC) conference;	Warsaw, Sept 2026;
	American Society of Criminology (ASC) conference;	Washington DC, Nov 2025;
Behavioral Economics	International Conference on Social Dilemmas (ICSDD);	Leiden, July 2024;
	Matterhorn Symposium;	Brig, Sept 2025;
	Cognition, Behavior, & Evolution Network (CBEN) ^{1,2} ;	¹ Maastricht, Oct 2024; ² Leiden, April 2026;
Management	Academy of Management (AOM) conference;	Boston 2023;
	Dutch Work & Organizational Psychology (WAOP) ^{1,2} ;	¹ Tilburg, Nov 2022; ² Groningen, Nov 2023;
Others: VR, CSS	XR meeting;	Würzburg, Oct 2025;
	VIRTUES VR meeting;	Hagen, Sept 2025;
	ODISSEI computational social science conference.	Utrecht, Nov 2022.

INVITED TALKS

- 2027 **Invited Award Lecture** at Association for Research in Personality (ARP) conference, June 2027 (scheduled), Chicago. Invited following receipt of the 2026 Tanaka Dissertation Award. *Unlocking Personality*.
- 2026 Technical University of Munich (TUM), Chair of Psychology, Colloquium on Motivation Research and Practice; Dec 2026 (scheduled). *TBA*.
- Berlin Science Week, Inspiration Stage Talk**; Berlin, Nov 2026 (scheduled). *Would you step in? The science of bystander courage*.
- 2025 EASP Small Group Meeting “The future of behavioral ethics”, Berlin, May 2025. *Incentivized dishonesty*.
- Matterhorn Symposium, Brig, Sept 2025. *Revisiting situational strength: Do Strong Situations Restrict Variance in Behaviors?*
- 2024 Beijing Normal University, Department of Psychology (host: Xiaomin Sun); Beijing, Dec 2024. *Behavior in context: How situational characteristics shape and regulate behavior*.
- Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security and Law; Freiburg, Dec 2024. *Behavior in context: How situational characteristics shape and regulate behavior*.

GRANTS, AWARDS

Grants/Fellowships

- 2026 **Humboldt Postdoc Fellowship**: two-year fellowship (approx. €90k)
- 2025 **Chinese Government Award for Outstanding PhDs**: \$6,000
- 2024 **DAAD (German Academic Exchange Service) Research Grant**: Bi-nationally Supervised Doctoral Degrees, €1,300 × 7 months
- 2024 **iBBA Online Experiment Grant** €2,500, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam
- 2021 Kurt Lewin Institute (KLI) **SeedCorn Research Grant** €3,000

Awards

- 2026 **Tanaka Dissertation Award (2026)**, along with an invited talk and travel stipend \$1000, Association for Research in Personality (ARP)
- 2024 **Best Student Presentation Award**, International Conference on Social Dilemmas (ICSD), Leiden, Netherlands
- 2024 **Runner-up for the Best Paper Award**, Kurt Lewin Institute, Netherlands
- 2022 **Best Paper Award**, Working community of Dutch Work & Organizational Psychology (WAOP) conference, Tilburg, Netherlands

Scholarship

- 2024 Travel Grant European Conference of Personality (ECP)

- 2023 Academy of Management (AOM) conference registration scholarship
- 2017 DAAD (German Grant Institute) - STIBET fellowship
- 2014 - 2018 Soochow University Scholarship for outstanding academic performance (*7 times);
Franklin Scholarships for Dual Degree of Soochow University (*3 times). Sum up to
NT\$ 400,000 ($\approx$ 12,680€)

ADVANCED TRAINING (SELECTED)

- Small Group Meeting “Beyond the blur of self-regulation research”. *Graz, June 2026*.
- Spring School “Experimental research moral judgement & (un)ethical behavior”. *Wittenberg, Mar 2026*.
- Summer School of the European Society of Criminology (ESC). *Lausanne, June 2025*.
- Small Group Meeting “The future of behavioral ethics: Social perspectives on dishonesty”. *Berlin, May 2025*.
- Philosophy of Science Workshop, *Freiburg, Feb 2025*.
- Summer School of Personality Science (SSPS). *Madrid, Aug 2022*.

REVIEWING

- Personality and Social Psychology Review: *Emerging Editorial Board (2023–2025; 4)*;
- European Journal of Personality (4);
- Collabra: Psychology (1);
- Health Psychology (1);
- Zeitschrift für Psychologie (1);
- Current Research in Ecological and Social Psychology (1);
- Social Psychology (1);
- European Journal on Criminal Policy and Research (1);
- SAGE Handbook of Survey Development and Application (1).

SUPERVISION, MENTORING, TEACHING

- Thesis supervision** Master thesis supervision and assessment, *Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam*.
Sebastiaan Schulter (2023–2024),
Savannah Huxtable (2023–2024),
Daria Hovorukha (student from Ukraine, 2022–2023),
Lara Vogel (2022–2023),
Zihan Wang (2022–2023),
Chenyu Tang (2021–2022),
Sofia Canelos (2021–2022),
Nora Choa (2020–2022).
- Bachelor thesis supervision, *Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam*
Roe Bakker (2021–2022).
- Guest Lecture Invited Guest Lecture “Personality in Organizational Settings”, Feb 2024,
Amsterdam Business School, University of Amsterdam.

Grading	Grading master's course 'Personality at Work', <i>Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam</i> Grading bachelor's course 'Methodological Research Projects', <i>University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam Business School</i> .
Mentoring	BOGY internship student Alina Schwalbe (10th-grade), April 2026, <i>Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security and Law</i> .
Journal club host	Grant proposal writing: June 2026, <i>Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security and Law</i> .

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Translations for cross-cultural projects @*Psychological Science Accelerator* (and colleagues) to enhance the generalizability of psychological science.

Speaker: Inspiration stage talk @*Berlin Science Week* (Nov 2026, scheduled). Would you step in? The science of bystander courage.

Columnist: Promote science communication in personality-social psychology, promote methodological rigor in scientific practices. Selected blogs include:

- ❖ The Soul of Science: On integrity in an age of pragmatic academia. (2025).
<https://ranranli.net/blogs/soul-of-science.html> (English).
- ❖ How situational settings influence behavior: New insights from behavioral research. (2024).
Kudos: American Psychological Association (APA) showcases.
<https://www.growkudos.com/publications/10.1037%252Fpspi0000475/>
- ❖ Recent Development in Personality Assessment. (2022). Amsterdam Leadership Lab.
<https://www.amsterdamleadershiplab.nl/recent-development-in-personality-assessment>
- ❖ AOM 2020 Reflections: Insights from the Academy of Management Annual Meeting. (2020).
<https://ranranli.net/blogs/aom2020.html> (English);
<https://mp.weixin.qq.com/s/iVOEuHauUwGY9PTO7S6aSw> (Chinese).
- ❖ Big Data Analytics in Psychology and Management Research. (2020).
<https://ranranli.net/blogs/bigdata.html> (English);
<https://mp.weixin.qq.com/s/zg01AE3mKxQ7HWQkwTtBDA> (Chinese).
- ❖ Is Psychology a useless discipline? (2020) (Chinese)
- ❖ The Limitations of p -value and Bayesian hypothesis testing. (2019).
<https://ranranli.net/blogs/pvalue-bayes.html> (English);
<https://mp.weixin.qq.com/s/TBc3Yvd7aBpFt4Dmt7r9Q> (Chinese).
- ❖ Questionable Research Practices (QRPs) in Social Science Research. (2021).
<https://ranranli.net/blogs/qtps.html> (English);
<https://mp.weixin.qq.com/s/1fDL5gUYtRjIs2bHHXJmBA> (Chinese).